

Usage Guide

DocsForge is a drop-in replacement for MkDocs + Material. This guide covers daily usage, from creating a new site to deploying it.

Quick Start

Create a New Site

```
# Install DocsForge
pip install docsforge

# Create a new project interactively
docsforge
cd my-docs

# Build and serve
docsforge serve
```

Build an Existing Site

```
cd your-project
# Edit docsforge.yml, then:
docsforge build
# Output goes to site/
```

Commands

Command	Description	Example
<code>docsforge</code>	Create a new project interactively	<code>docsforge</code>
<code>docsforge build</code>	Build the site	<code>docsforge build</code>
<code>docsforge serve</code>	Build + serve locally with live reload	<code>docsforge serve</code>
<code>docsforge --version</code>	Show version	<code>docsforge --version</code>

Command	Description	Example
<code>docsforge --help</code>	Show help	<code>docsforge --help</code>

Configuration (`docsforge.yml`)

Basic Config

```
site_name: My Documentation
site_url: https://example.com/docs
site_description: A great docs site
site_author: Your Name

copyright: Copyright © 2025

nav:
  - Home: index.md
  - Getting Started: getting-started.md
  - Reference: reference.md

docs_dir: docs
site_dir: site
```

Theme Customization

```
theme:
  name: material
  logo: assets/logo.png
  favicon: assets/favicon.png

palette:
  - media: "(prefers-color-scheme: light)"
    scheme: default
    primary: indigo
    accent: indigo
    toggle:
      icon: material/brightness-7
      name: Switch to dark mode
  - media: "(prefers-color-scheme: dark)"
    scheme: slate
    primary: indigo
    accent: indigo
    toggle:
      icon: material/brightness-4
      name: Switch to light mode

features:
  - navigation.tabs
  - navigation.sections
  - navigation.expand
```

- navigation.path
- navigation.top
- search.suggest
- search.highlight
- content.code.copy
- content.code.annotate
- content.action.edit

Language & Search

```
theme:
  language: en

# Multi-language search pipeline
search:
  language: en
  pipeline:
    - stemmer
    - stopWordFilter
    - trimmer
```

Markdown Extensions

```
markdown_extensions:
  - admonition
  - pymdownx.details
  - pymdownx.superfences:
      custom_fences:
        - name: mermaid
          class: mermaid
          format: !!python/name:pymdownx.superfences.fence_code_format
  - pymdownx.tabbed:
      alternate_style: true
  - pymdownx.tasklist:
      custom_checkbox: true
  - pymdownx.emoji:
      emoji_index: !!python/name:docsforge.emoji.twemoji
      emoji_generator: !!python/name:docsforge.emoji.to_svg
  - tables
  - toc:
      permalink: true
```

Plugins

Built-in plugins are loaded automatically. You only need to declare plugins when you want to customize them:

```
plugins:
  - search:
      lang: en
```

```
- tags:
  tags_file: tags.md
- blog:
  blog_dir: blog
  blog_toc: true
```

Content Features

Admonitions (Callouts)

```
!!! note
    This is a note.

!!! warning "Be careful"
    This is a warning with a custom title.

!!! tip
    This is a tip.

    It can have multiple paragraphs.

!!! danger
    Don't do this!
```

Code Blocks

```
```python
print("hello")
```

```
key: value
```

```
With annotations:
```markdown
```python
print("hello") # (1)!
```

1. 🗨️ This is an annotation!

```
Content Tabs
```markdown
=== "Python"

    ```python
 print("hello")
    ```

=== "JavaScript"
```

```
```javascript
console.log("hello");
```
```

Task Lists

- ☒ Completed task
- ☐ Incomplete task
- ☐ Another task

Mermaid Diagrams

```
```mermaid
graph LR
 A[Start] --> B{Decision}
 B -->|Yes| C[Action 1]
 B -->|No| D[Action 2]
```

```
Math (KaTeX)
```markdown
Inline:  $E = mc^2$ 

Block:

$$\sum_{i=1}^n x_i = x_1 + x_2 + \cdots + x_n$$

```

Tags

```
---
tags:
- tutorial
- beginner
---

# My Page
```

Git Integration

Revision Dates

DocsForge automatically shows when each page was last updated, powered by git history. No plugin configuration is needed.

Edit Links

```
edit_uri: edit/main/docs/
```

Adds an "Edit this page" button linking to your repo.

PWA / Offline Support

DocsForge generates a Progressive Web App automatically. Features:

- **Offline access:** Service worker caches pages
- **Installable:** Add to home screen on mobile
- **Auto-update:** Checks for new content on each visit

No configuration needed — it's automatic!

Search

Full-text search is built-in. Features:

- **Instant results:** Search as you type
- **Highlighting:** Matches highlighted in results
- **Suggestions:** Auto-complete suggestions
- **Multi-language:** Supports Chinese, English, and more

Asset Handling

Images

```
! [Alt text] (assets/image.png)
```

Place images in `docs/assets/` (or your `docs_dir`).

CSS & JS

```
extra_css:  
  - stylesheets/custom.css  
extra_javascript:  
  - javascripts/custom.js
```

Place files in `docs/stylesheets/` and `docs/javascripts/`.

Performance Tips

Incremental Builds

Both `docsforge build` and `docsforge serve` use incremental builds by default. Only changed pages are rebuilt, which is fast for large sites.

Build Optimization

DocsForge automatically optimizes after each build:

- Removes unused icons and assets
- Strips source maps
- Removes old font formats (keeps only WOFF2)
- Gzips sitemap

No manual steps needed.

Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
<code>ModuleNotFoundError</code>	<code>pip install docsforge</code>
Theme not found	DocsForge bundles Material — no extra install needed
Search not working	Ensure <code>search</code> plugin is in <code>plugins: list</code>
CSS not loading	Check path is relative to <code>docs_dir</code>
Build is slow	Incremental builds are on by default; restart <code>docsforge serve</code> if needed
Icons missing	Use <code>material/</code> prefix (e.g., <code>material/home</code>)

Next Steps

- [Publishing](#) → — Deploy to GitHub Pages, Netlify, Vercel, and more
- [Migration Guide](#) — Moving from MkDocs/Material
- [Changelog](#) — What's new

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